

Complete pH & Acid-Base Equations (Lectures 1–5)

1. Basic Definitions

$$\text{pH} = -\log[\text{H}^+]$$

$$\text{pOH} = -\log[\text{OH}^-]$$

$$\text{pH} + \text{pOH} = 14$$

Example: If $[\text{H}^+] = 10^{-3} \rightarrow \text{pH} = 3$

2. Ion Product of Water

$$K_w = [\text{H}^+][\text{OH}^-] = 10^{-14}$$

Example: If $[\text{H}^+] = 10^{-5} \rightarrow [\text{OH}^-] = 10^{-9}$

3. Strong Acids

Fully dissociated: $[\text{H}^+] = \text{concentration}$

$$\text{pH} = -\log[\text{H}^+]$$

Example: 0.1 M HCl $\rightarrow \text{pH} = 1$

4. Strong Bases

$$\text{pOH} = -\log[\text{OH}^-]$$

$$\text{pH} = 14 - \text{pOH}$$

Example: 0.01 M NaOH $\rightarrow \text{pH} = 12$

5. Weak Acids

$$\text{pH} = \frac{1}{2} \text{pK}_a + \frac{1}{2} \text{pC}_a$$

Example: $\text{pK}_a = 4.76$, $\text{C}_a = 0.1 \rightarrow \text{pH} = 2.88$

6. Weak Bases

$$\text{pH} = 14 - \frac{1}{2} \text{pK}_b - \frac{1}{2} \text{pC}_b$$

Example: $\text{pK}_b = 4.76$, $\text{C}_b = 0.1 \rightarrow \text{pH} = 11.12$

7. Buffers (Henderson-Hasselbalch)

Acidic buffer: $\text{pH} = \text{pK}_a + \log(\text{salt}/\text{acid})$ $\Rightarrow [\text{salt}]/[\text{acid}]$ [] $\Rightarrow$ refers to concentration

Example: equal concentrations $\rightarrow \text{pH} = \text{pK}_a$

Basic buffer: $\text{pH} = 14 - \text{pK}_b - \log(\text{salt}/\text{base})$

Example: $\text{NH}_4\text{OH}/\text{NH}_4\text{Cl} \rightarrow \text{pH} = 8.24$

8. Salt Hydrolysis

Strong acid + strong base $\rightarrow \text{pH} = 7$

Strong acid + weak base $\rightarrow$ acidic

Weak acid + strong base $\rightarrow$ basic

Weak acid + weak base $\rightarrow$ depends on K_a & K_b

9. Indicators

$\text{pH} = \text{pK}_{\text{In}} \pm 1$ $\text{pK}_{\text{In}} \Rightarrow$ means pK Indicator

Example: Phenolphthalein range = $8.3 - 10$

10. Buffer Capacity

Maximum when $[\text{salt}] = [\text{acid}]$

$\text{pH} = \text{pK}_a \pm 1$

11. Titration Key Equations

Strong acid–strong base $\rightarrow \text{pH} = 7$ at equivalence

Weak acid–strong base $\rightarrow \text{pH} > 7$

Weak base–strong acid $\rightarrow \text{pH} < 7$